

09 Software Tools and Options – Walkthrough

(White board; internet access for showing where to download tools in bibleineverylanguage.org – 30 min.) (**Note:** It may be good to have the oral or written conversation [see module 05] before introducing tools, so that this walkthrough can focus on the tools that fit the team's desired end-product.)

Intro: In this session we want to show you some of the software that Wycliffe Associates offers to help teams translate and preserve their work. Many software options exist, but Wycliffe Associates is committed to providing **free software** with **free resources** for translators to use in checking their translation. Another important aspect of using Wycliffe Associates software is that all data can be freely uploaded to Wycliffe Associates Content Servers (WACS) for **storage** and use.

Explain: Several software options exist and are available for download at bibleineverylanguage.org. (If you have internet access, go to bibleineverylanguage.org and show where to download these. Be sure to familiarize yourself with these programs on BIEL ahead of time so that this goes smoothly.)

Remember that the local church decides which translation format to use—a written translation that people can read using an accepted writing system for their language community, or an oral translation that people can listen to using an MP3 player or smart phone. Remember that each language group knows what is right for their own community. We want to show you what we offer for free, but leaders for each language group are the best ones to decide what to use, because they know their own people.

Ask: Have you talked about whether you will have an oral or a written translation? (*Encourage them to tell you what they are thinking, and what decisions they have made.*) How many people in your community read and write? How will those who do not read or write be able to hear the Scriptures in your language, once your translation is complete?

Explain: If a written translation is best for the community.

- Writer is good if a tablet or computer is available for translators to use. Not every translator has to have a computer for this option: translators can do all their work with pen and paper and then have a typist who will be responsible for entering their text into Writer.
 - Writer includes translation resources embedded in the program, so no internet access is necessary to use those resources.
 - Multi-language keyboard--Writer supports keyboards in up to 15 different languages, with more in development.
 - Writer is accessible on Android devices and Windows, Linux, and Apple computers.
 - Work done in Writer can be safely stored in WA online Content Server.

Explain: If an oral translation is best for the community, or if there is a need to record a translation that is already written, we offer two options.

- Recorder provides an intuitive solution for using Android devices to begin orally translating the Bible into a heart language for people who are not comfortable with technology.
 - Project management--Recorder offers several features to help manage translations, such as auto-naming files and tracking progress.
 - Source audio files included
 - Basic editing and simple recording.
- Orature simplifies the creation of audio Scripture, easing translation and narration for tech-hesitant translators.
 - Audio Narration--Orature makes it easy to complete Scripture recording of a written Bible in the language of your choosing.
 - Oral Translation--Draft, edit, and compile a Bible translation project all in one place.
 - Backup and Export options
 - 3rd Party Support--Orature works with multiple 3rd party applications, such as OcenAudio, Adobe Audition, and more.

Review: Think about these options. Which of them would work well for your community. *(Pause to let them discuss options and ask questions.)*

Ask: When you think about your language community, which of these tools might best serve your needs? Things to consider include:

- Does anyone on the team own laptop computers or tablets that could be used for this project?
- Is internet available in your community? If not, how often can you travel to a place with good internet to upload translated material?
- Are people in your community used to using computers?

Share: Psalm 102:18 says, “Let this be written for a future generation, that a people not yet created may praise the Lord.” Your Bible translation is not just for today; it is for future generations to know and praise the Lord. We want to help everyone to use the right tools to be able not only to serve their own local church, but to preserve the Scriptures for future generations. These software tools are designed with that purpose in mind.

Confirm: Choosing the right translation tool for your team is essential for two primary reasons: (1) The right tool will support the format you have chosen for your translation. (2) Using the correct tool leads to preservation of the translation for future publishing.